Environmental Psychology



Lecture four

Environmental Attitudes & Assessments

Part One

- Environmental Attitudes

Part Two

- Environmental Appraisals

Consequence of perception and behavior after establishing built environment

what's in and what's out

- Artificial spaces – enclosed by buildings or constructions *in*
- Architecture adds man-made aesthetics (human culture) *in*
- Man-made (geometric) green spaces *in*
- Neighborhood - Community – town – city *in*
- Noise, air pollution, heat island *in*

- Biological creatures moving *out*
- Some water *out*
- Clean air, blue sky *out*
- Natural green *out*
- Forest *out*

Environmental Attitude

- **An attitude** can be defined as a tendency to evaluate an object or an idea in positive or negative way. That is, attitudes involve affect or emotion – feelings of pleasantness or unpleasantness, like or dislike, for something.

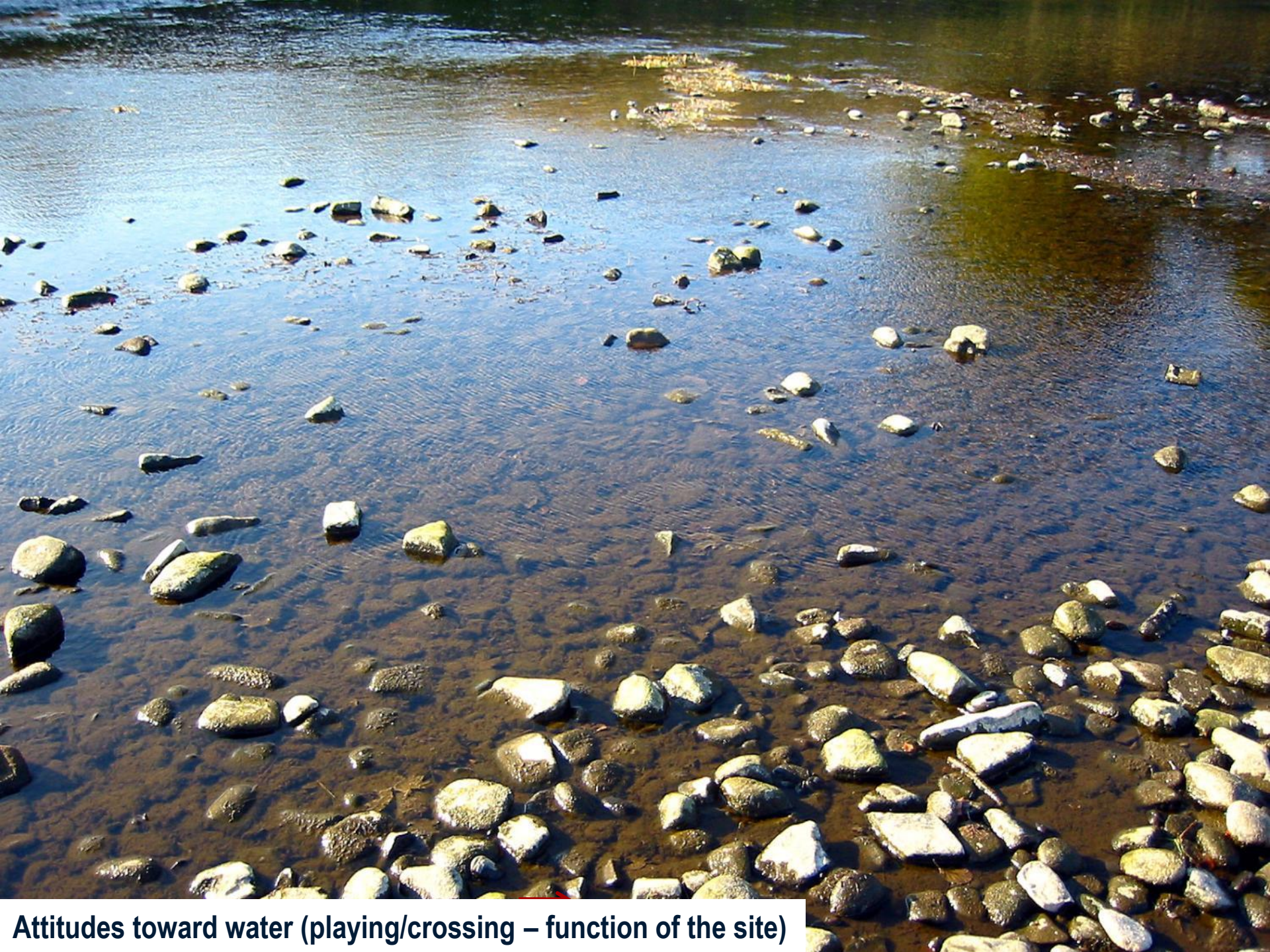
- Since environmental perception includes affective and cognitive components, it is easy to see that **environmental perception and environmental attitudes** are closely related, together shaping **people's attitudes** toward the environment, which may subsequently cause actions toward modifying or interacting with the environment.



Australia- why like this (great barrier reef/kola) – attitudes to Australia



Attitudes to Mahdavis



Attitudes toward water (playing/crossing – function of the site)



Attitudes toward the square (assembly: gossip, scandal?)



Attitudes toward the square (entrance and transport)



Attitudes toward the Street (shopping/passing)



Attitudes toward the Street (cafeteria)



Attitudes toward the street corner (behavior art, lively, bustling, not lonely)

Environment attitudes

- **Environmental attitudes** are broadly defined as an individual's concern for the physical environment as something that is worthy of protection, understanding, or enhancement.
- **Environmental attitudes** can inform these individuals how much or little support exists for specific programs or the environment in general.
- **Environmental attitudes** can help in the setting of environmental goals (e.g., 60 percent of newspapers to be recycled within two years).
- Why: Although attitudes do not always translate into action, they can be very useful for environmental managers such as park superintendents, fish and game officers, forestry officials, building managers, and recycling coordinators.

Environment attitudes

- **Environmental attitudes** can include any attitude related to nature and architecture (built environment).

bustling or noisy (crowding or not crowding)





Environment attitudes

- Components of environmental attitudes: cognitive (know), affective (emotional), conative (behavior).
- The cognitive component refers to what an individual knows or thinks about a place, including facts and opinions about it.
- The affective component refers to the emotional aspects of attitudes toward the place.
- The conative component relates to an individual's behavioral intentions toward the place.





From attitudes to appraisal

- **Environmental attitudes** can indicate with some accuracy what people are doing about the environment now, or at least what they intend to do.

- **Environmental appraisal** refers to at least six kinds of personal impressions in addition to environment concern: descriptions, evaluations, judgments of beauty (aesthetics), emotional reactions, meanings, and risk or safety.

Environment appraisal

- **Environmental appraisal** is one judgment of environmental attitudes.
- **Environmental appraisal** refers to an individual's personal impression of a setting. It involves an observer and a place, in which more emphasis is placed on understanding the person than understanding the place.
- **Environmental appraisal** refers to at least six kinds of personal impressions in addition to environment concern: descriptions, evaluations, judgments of beauty (aesthetics), emotional reactions, meanings, and risk or safety.
- To car use, environmental appraisal concerns on willing, reluctant, usable, possible of cars and usage facilities, but not outcomes of a physical environment.



Water sport is needed



Beautiful scene is valued for tourism



- Given all we know about people and the particular environment they are in, some behaviors **are more likely to occur** than others.
- **Social and psychological phenomena** are to some extent influenced by **architecture and design**.



- **Design elements** have been found to affect our behavior **across a wide variety of settings**

- **A variety of responses** in any environmental situation, there are probabilities associated with specific instances of design and behavior.



There are probabilities associated with specific instances of design and behavior.





Mitigating or adapting to air pollution



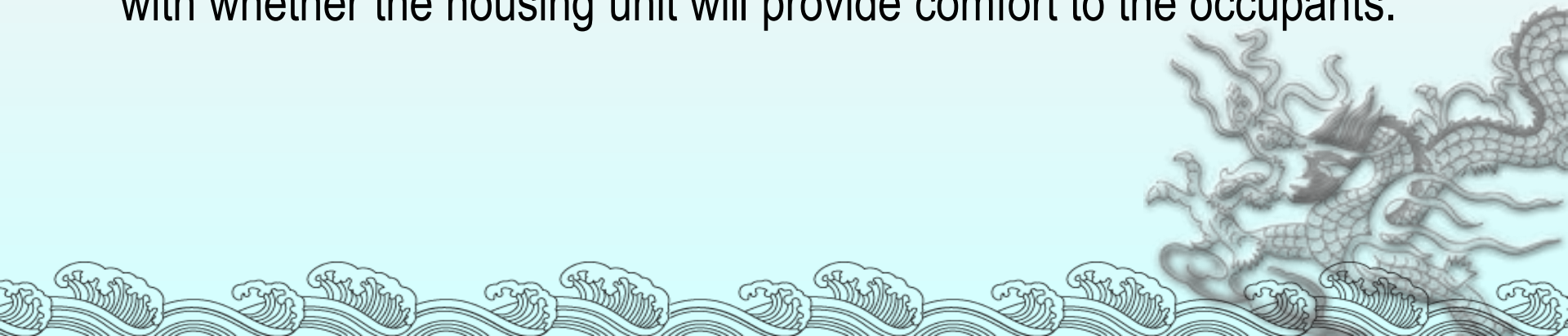
Mitigating or adapting to nocturnal night urban skyglow



Mitigating or adapting to traffic noise

Why environmental psychology in design

- Human behavior is responsible for much of the urban pollution and many of the sustainability challenges.
- Given any particular environmental concern, a number of fields of psychology have plenty to offer – **environmental psychology**.
- Considering the problems of housing design, principles of crowding, privacy, personal space, environmental perception, as well as *effects of noise, heat island, and air circulation on behavior* have much to do with whether the housing unit will provide comfort to the occupants.



Impacts of Large-Scale Built Environments: megacities



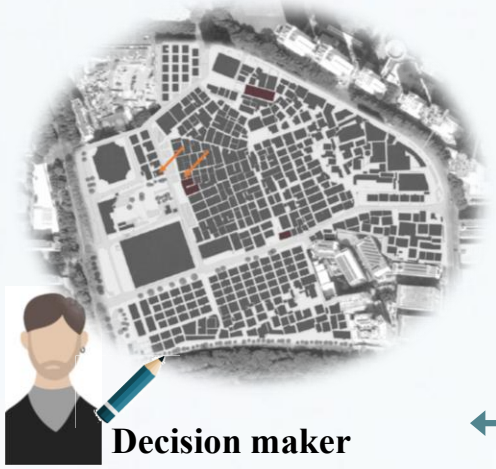
Industrial activity
– products producing



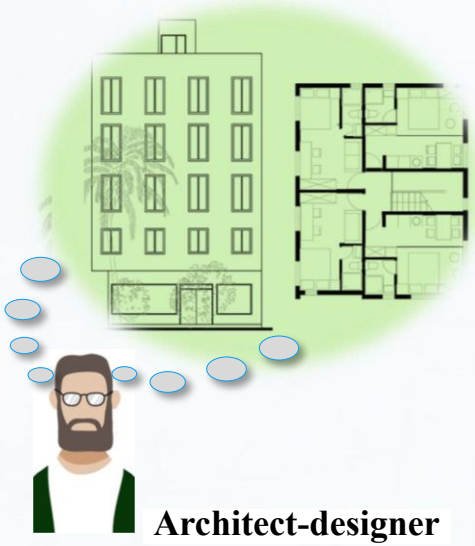
Transportation
- travelling behavior



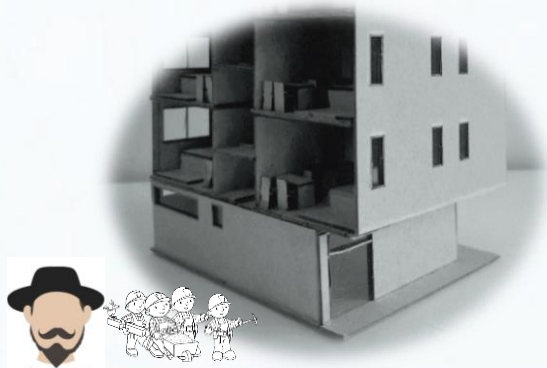
Waste
- The worst by-product of cities
(human consuming more than any other living lives in this world)



Decision maker



Architect-designer



Contractor

?

?





Researcher



User



End of the Forth Lecture

Thanks for attention

Any questions? (leilayu@hit.edu.cn)